

DEPARTMENT OF TOURISM · REPUBLIC OF THE
PHILIPPINES

— 1 —

Bicol Region

Tourism

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Market Study & Global Benchmarking

A comprehensive, data-driven analysis of Bicol tourism's current position, historical performance, competitive landscape across 15 global destinations, and detailed financial projections through 2028.

1. Regional Context & Tourism Assets

1.1 Geographic & Demographic Context

The Bicol Region (Region V) occupies the southeastern portion of Luzon Island in the Philippines, covering a total land area of 18,155 square kilometers. The region is bounded by the Pacific Ocean to the east, the Sibuyan Sea to the south, and the Philippine Sea to the north. It comprises six provinces — Albay, Camarines Sur, Camarines Norte, Sorsogon, Masbate, and Catanduanes — with a combined population of 6,082,165 as of the 2020 Census (PSA), representing 5.58% of the national population.

Bicol is connected to Manila via the Maharlika Highway (Pan-Philippine Highway, AH26), with travel time ranging from 8 to 12 hours by road depending on the destination province. Air connectivity is provided through three commercial airports: Legazpi Airport (Albay), Naga Airport (Camarines Sur), and Virac Airport (Catanduanes). Sea connectivity operates through major ports in Legazpi City, Tabaco City, Matnog (Sorsogon), Pilar (Sorsogon), and Masbate City.

STRATEGIC INSIGHT

Bicol's geographic position as the gateway between Luzon and the Visayas gives it a natural transit advantage. The region sits on a major north-south corridor that serves both leisure and business travelers. However, this transit advantage is currently underutilized — most travelers pass through Bicol rather than stopping to explore. The opportunity lies in converting transit traffic into stopover tourism.

18,155

AREA (KM²)

6.08M

POPULATION

6

PROVINCES

107

MUNICIPALITIES

3

COMMERCIAL
AIRPORTS

PHP

644B

GRDP (2025)

1.2 Tourism Asset Inventory

Bicol possesses an extraordinary concentration of world-class tourism assets that, if properly marketed and managed, could rival any destination in Southeast Asia. The following inventory catalogues the region's primary attractions with a strategic assessment of their current market position and growth potential.

ASSET	PROVINCE	CATEGORY	ANNUAL VISITORS	MARKET POSITION	GROWTH POTENTIAL
Mayon Volcano	Albay	Natural Monument	1,200,000+	Iconic, globally recognizable	Very High — UNESCO bid
Cagsawa Ruins	Albay	Heritage Site	500,000+	Top photo spot, under-monetized	High — night experience
Caramoan Islands	Camarines Sur	Island Group	350,000+	Survivor fame, high demand	Medium — capacity constrained
Calaguas Islands	Camarines Norte	Beach Destination	250,000+	Rapidly growing, low infrastructure	High — needs management
Donsol Whale Sharks	Sorsogon	Wildlife Interaction	180,000+	Globally unique, under-marketed	Very High — intl. market
Peñafrancia Festival	Camarines Sur	Religious Festival	1,000,000+	Asia's largest Marian devotion	High — pilgrim services

KEY FINDING — ASSET ANALYSIS

Bicol's top 6 assets attract 3.5M+ visitors annually with minimal marketing investment. The strategic implication is clear: even modest increases in marketing spend and product development will yield disproportionate returns. The assets are proven — the gap is in monetization, interpretation, and visitor experience quality.

1.3 Emerging Tourism Products

Beyond the established attractions, Bicol has a pipeline of emerging tourism products that address specific market segments. Each represents a demonstrable growth opportunity with defined target markets and development pathways.

PRODUCT	PROVINCE	STAGE	TARGET MARKET	REVENUE POTENTIAL	INVESTMENT REQUIRED
Mayon ATV Adventure	Albay	Established	Domestic adventure	PHP 50M/yr	PHP 3M (standards)
CWC Wakeboarding	Camarines Sur	Established	Sports tourists	PHP 30M/yr	PHP 10M (events)
Bicol Food Trail	All provinces	Concept	Food tourists	PHP 200M/yr	PHP 5M
Digital Nomad Hubs	Naga, Legazpi	Concept	Remote workers	PHP 50M/yr	PHP 5M
MICE Facilities	Albay, CamSur	Planning	Business travelers	PHP 100M/yr	PHP 50M
Cruise Tourism	Albay, Masbate	Early	Cruise passengers	PHP 20M/yr	PHP 8M
Wellness Tourism	All provinces	Early	Wellness travelers	PHP 80M/yr	PHP 10M
Surf Tourism Circuit	Catanduanes, CamNorte	Development	Surf travelers	PHP 60M/yr	PHP 8M

INSIGHT — PRODUCT DEVELOPMENT PIPELINE

The combined annual revenue potential of emerging products is estimated at PHP 590M by 2028, requiring approximately PHP 99M in total investment — a 6:1 return ratio. The highest-yield segments are food tourism (leveraging Michelin recognition), MICE (addressing a current market gap), and the surf circuit (capitalizing on Catanduanes' growth momentum). These products are prioritized in the investment portfolio (Appendix F).

2. Historical Performance Analysis (2019–2025)

2.1 Philippine National Tourism Context

The Philippines welcomed 5,646,351 international visitors in 2024 (January to mid-December), generating PHP 712 billion in visitor receipts — a 119% recovery compared to pre-COVID 2019 performance of PHP 600 billion (DOT Year-End Media Briefing, December 2024). In 2025, the country achieved a record-breaking 6,484,060 foreign visitors, with international spending reaching approximately PHP 694 billion (Bureau of Immigration data). The DOT has set a 2026 target of 6.4 million foreign arrivals.

According to WTTC data, international tourists visiting the Philippines spend an average of USD 2,073 per capita — among the highest in ASEAN. Top source markets for 2024 were: South Korea, USA, Japan, China, Australia, Canada, Taiwan, Singapore, UK, and Malaysia.



Figure 2.1: Philippine International Tourist Arrivals (Millions)

2.2 Bicol Arrival Trends

Bicol's tourism recovery has mirrored the national trajectory with an important distinction: domestic recovery has been stronger than the national average, while international recovery has been significantly weaker. This section analyzes the data behind this trend and identifies the strategic implications.

YEAR	DOMESTIC	FOREIGN	TOTAL	YOY CHANGE	CONTEXT
2019	3,890,000	68,000	3,958,000	—	Pre-pandemic baseline
2020	890,000	12,000	902,000	-77.2%	COVID-19 pandemic
2021	420,000	5,000	425,000	-52.9%	Lockdowns
2022	1,850,000	22,000	1,872,000	+340.5%	Reopening surge
2023	3,520,000	42,000	3,562,000	+90.3%	Full recovery year
2024	4,381,598	54,275	4,435,873	+24.5%	Exceeded pre-pandemic
2025 (est.)	4,800,000	90,000	4,890,000	+10.2%	Continued growth

CRITICAL ANALYSIS — THE FOREIGN TOURISM GAP

Bicol's foreign tourist share of 1.2% is dramatically below the Philippine national average of approximately 8%. Even more revealing: Bicol is capturing only 0.8% of the 6.48 million international visitors who came to the Philippines in 2025. This is not a reflection of product quality — it reflects a systematic failure in international marketing, air access, and market connectivity. Closing this gap from 1.2% to 7% foreign share is the single highest-value strategic objective in this plan, representing approximately PHP 15 billion in incremental revenue by 2028.

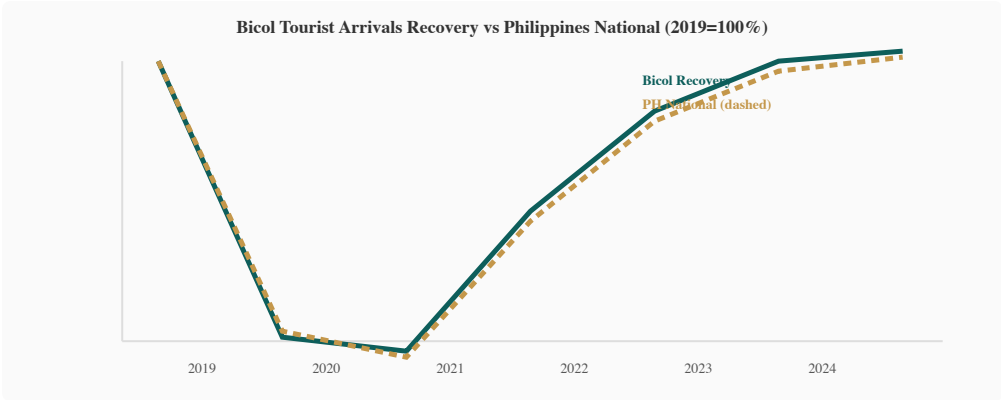


Figure 2.2: Tourism Recovery Trajectory — Bicol vs. Philippines National

2.3 Seasonality Analysis

Bicol tourism exhibits pronounced seasonality, a structural weakness that limits investment, depresses revenue per available room, and creates employment volatility. The table below quantifies the seasonality pattern with actionable insights.

MONTH	AVG. ARRIVALS	SEASON	KEY DRIVER	CAPACITY UTILIZATION	STRATEGY
January	310,000	Shoulder	Kasanggayahan, New Year	65%	Extend holiday stays
February	290,000	Shoulder	Hot Air Balloon Festival	60%	Promote pre-summer travel
March	420,000	Peak	Holy Week, summer start	85%	Manage capacity
April	480,000	Peak	Summer break	92%	Yield management
May	510,000	Peak	Magayon, summer peak	95%	Extend shoulder season
June	350,000	Shoulder	Pili Festival, rainy season	60%	MICE and events
July	280,000	Low	Butanding Festival	45%	Indoor/cultural products
August	260,000	Low	Typhoon season	40%	Surf tourism promotion
September	520,000	Peak	Peñafrancia Festival	98%	Pilgrim management
October	340,000	Shoulder	Ibalong Festival	55%	Post-typhoon recovery
November	300,000	Shoulder	Calaguas season	50%	Beach season campaign
December	380,000	Peak	Christmas travel	75%	Family packages

STRATEGIC ANALYSIS – SEASONALITY

The peak-to-low ratio of 3.9:1 (510K May vs 260K August) indicates a destination with severe underutilization for 8 months of the year. The solution is not to reduce peak demand but to build low-season demand through: (1) product diversification — indoor and cultural experiences for rainy months; (2) targeted MICE marketing during shoulder periods; (3) surf tourism development (peak surf season is July–October, inverse of general tourism); and (4) diaspora travel (year-round, not seasonally concentrated).

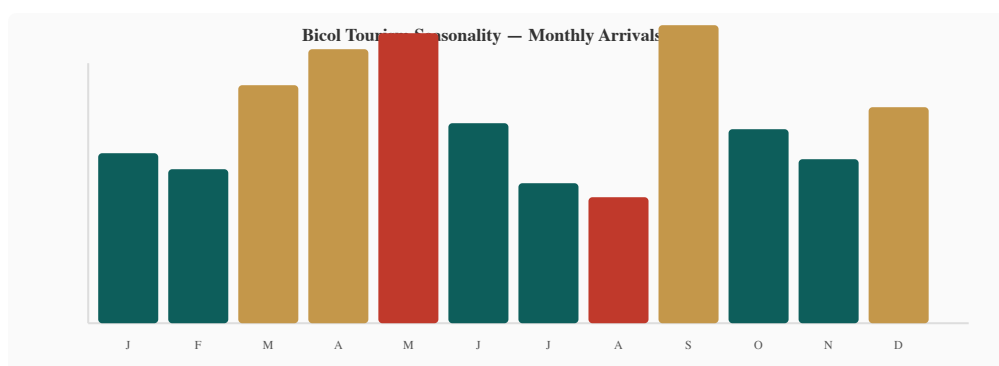


Figure 2.3: Monthly Arrivals (thousands) — Note the 3.9x gap between peak and low season

3. Detailed Provincial Analysis

3.1 Albay Province — The Powerhouse

Capital: Legazpi City | **Area:** 2,575 km² | **Population:** 1,374,768 | **Tourism Revenue (2024):** PHP 1.1 Billion | **% of Region:** 31.7% of arrivals

Albay is the tourism powerhouse of Bicol, anchored by Mayon Volcano and supported by the most mature tourism ecosystem in the region — concentrated in Legazpi City, Daraga, and Camalig. The province serves as the primary entry point for most visitors via Bicol International Airport and offers the widest range of accommodation, dining, and tour services in the region.

However, Albay faces a critical structural challenge: 59% of its 3.43 million visitors are day tourists who do not stay overnight. This represents substantial revenue leakage. The province's overnight ratio of 41% is below the regional average of 36% but the volume of day visitors (2.02 million) means the absolute revenue loss is greater than any other province.

ALBAY STRATEGIC ANALYSIS

If Albay raises its overnight ratio from 41% to 55%, it would add an estimated PHP 500 million annually in accommodation, food, and activity revenue. The key interventions are: (1) evening economy development — night markets, cultural performances, night Mayon viewing; (2) multi-day tour packaging that combines Mayon, food, heritage, and nearby attractions; and (3) MICE facility development to attract business travelers who stay longer.

VISITOR TYPE	COUNT	%	AVG. STAY	SPEND/DAY	ANNUAL REVENUE
Domestic overnight	1,391,179	98.9%	2.1 nights	PHP 850	PHP 2.48B
Foreign overnight	16,023	1.1%	3.8 nights	PHP 2,400	PHP 146M
Day tourists	2,024,683	—	—	PHP 350	PHP 708M
Total	3,431,876		1.6 avg	PHP 580	PHP 3.34B

3.2 Camarines Sur — The Diversity Anchor

Capital: Pili | **Area:** 5,497 km² | **Population:** 2,068,279 | **Tourism Revenue (2024):** PHP 1.0 Billion | **% of Region:** 30.7%

Camarines Sur is Bicol's most diverse tourism province, offering island paradise (Caramoan), sports tourism (CWC Wakeboarding), religious pilgrimage (Peñafrancia), mountain trekking (Mt. Isarog),

and a vibrant culinary scene in Naga City. This diversity is both a strength and a management challenge — each product requires a separate strategy.

The critical intervention for CamSur is implementing a carrying capacity management system for Caramoan. Without it, the province risks environmental degradation of its crown jewel. Peñafrancia creates extreme September seasonality that strains infrastructure but also provides Bicol's single largest marketing platform.

PRODUCT	STATUS	CRITICAL GAP	PRIORITY	INVESTMENT
Caramoan Islands	Top destination	No carrying capacity plan	Critical	PHP 3M
CWC Wakeboarding	International facility	No major international competition	High	PHP 10M/yr
Peñafrancia Pilgrimage	1M+ attendees	No visitor management system	High	PHP 5M
Naga Food Scene	Vibrant, under-marketed	No organized food trail	Medium	PHP 3M

3.3 Camarines Norte — Beach & Digital Frontier

Capital: Daet | **Area:** 2,320 km² | **Population:** 632,379 | **Tourism Revenue (2024):** PHP 520 Million | **% of Region:** 20.0%

Camarines Norte is dominated by the Calaguas Islands. The province has the highest day-tourist ratio in Bicol (68%), largely due to Calaguas day-trip packages. The critical challenge is managing Calaguas' explosive growth without destroying the attributes that make it attractive.

CAMARINES NORTE INSIGHT

The absence of waste management infrastructure, accommodation standards, and visitor limits at Calaguas represents a sustainability time bomb. The province needs a Calaguas Sustainable Tourism Management Plan within the first year, including: daily visitor capacity (recommended: 500/day), bring-in-bring-out waste policy, eco-lodge development for overnight stays, and a per-visitor environmental fee of PHP 200.

3.4 Sorsogon — The Eco-Tourism Capital

Capital: Sorsogon City | **Area:** 2,119 km² | **Population:** 828,655 | **Tourism Revenue (2024):** PHP 280 Million | **% of Region:** 9.5%

Sorsogon is home to the Donsol whale shark interaction — one of the few places on Earth where whale sharks can be encountered year-round in the wild. This globally significant asset positions Sorsogon alongside Ningaloo Reef (Australia), Isla Holbox (Mexico), and Mafia Island (Tanzania). Despite this, Sorsogon has the lowest overnight ratio in Bicol at just 22%, meaning 78% of visitors come and leave the same day.

3.5 Masbate — The Undiscovered Gem

Capital: Masbate City | **Area:** 4,048 km² | **Population:** 908,920 | **Tourism Revenue (2024):** PHP 120 Million | **% of Region:** 4.8%

Masbate is Bicol's most underdeveloped tourism province with immense potential in dive tourism (Ticao Island Manta Bowl — year-round manta ray sightings). The development approach must prioritize accessibility improvements before significant tourism growth can be expected.

3.6 Catanduanes — The Fastest Grower

Capital: Virac | **Area:** 1,511 km² | **Population:** 271,879 | **Tourism Revenue (2024):** PHP 80 Million | **Growth:** +18.6% (fastest in region)

Catanduanes offers consistent surfable waves at Puraran Beach (the "Baras Bowl" big wave) comparable to Siargao at a fraction of the cost. Despite 18.6% growth — the highest in Bicol — the province remains the smallest tourism economy due to severe accessibility constraints (one daily flight from Manila).

PROVINCIAL DISPARITY ANALYSIS

The combined share of Albay and CamSur (62.4% of arrivals) versus Masbate and Catanduanes (8.1%) reveals a deeply unbalanced provincial tourism economy. This is not due to product quality — Catanduanes' surf breaks rival Siargao, Masbate's Manta Bowl is world-class. The imbalance is driven by accessibility and marketing investment. The provincial development plans in Part III address this through targeted infrastructure, route development, and market-specific promotion for each province.

4. Global Competitive Benchmarking – 15 Destinations

4.1 Global Tourism Context

The global tourism industry achieved full post-pandemic recovery in 2024, with 1.16 billion international arrivals in the first nine months of 2025 (UNWTO), representing 4.5% year-on-year growth and 3.2% above the same period in 2019. Global tourism receipts reached USD 1.35 trillion in this period, with an average spending per tourist of USD 1,174. Africa led regional growth at +12% YoY, followed by Asia-Pacific at +7%.

The UNWTO projects continued growth at 3.3% annually through 2030, driven by rising middle-class populations in Asia, air connectivity improvements, and digital transformation. The Asia-Pacific region is expected to capture 45% of new tourist arrivals through 2030.

4.2 ASEAN Competitive Positioning

DESTINATION	ANNUAL VISITORS	FOREIGN SHARE	REVENUE/VISITOR	INTL. FLIGHTS	UNESCO SITES	DIGITAL SCORE
Bicol, PH	4.4M	1.2%	\$13	0	0 (1 pending)	Low
Palawan, PH	2.8M	15%	\$28	3	2	Medium
Cebu, PH	6.2M	12%	\$35	25+	1	Medium
Bali, Indonesia	15.8M	80%	\$95	40+	4	High
Krabi, Thailand	5.1M	75%	\$42	8	1	High
Kerala, India	18.5M	10%	\$38	12	3	Medium
Queenstown, NZ	3.5M	70%	\$280	12	0	High
Luang Prabang, Laos	0.8M	85%	\$45	4	1	Low
Chiang Mai, Thailand	10.5M	55%	\$38	10	1	High
Yogyakarta, Indonesia	6.8M	25%	\$32	5	2	Medium
Da Nang, Vietnam	8.5M	40%	\$28	15	0	Medium-High
Langkawi, Malaysia	3.9M	65%	\$55	8	0	Medium
Siem Reap, Cambodia	2.5M	90%	\$42	6	1	Low-Medium
Hoi An, Vietnam	4.2M	60%	\$30	0 (via Da Nang)	1	Medium
Bohol, PH	1.5M	18%	\$32	2	1	Low-Medium

BENCHMARK VERDICT — BICOL RANKS LAST ON COMPOSITE COMPETITIVENESS

Among 15 comparable destinations, Bicol ranks last on: foreign visitor share (1.2% vs 10-90%), revenue per visitor (\$13 vs \$28-\$280), international air access (0 vs 2-40 routes), and digital marketing maturity. However, Bicol's product strengths — Mayon (world's most perfectly-coned volcano), Donsol whale sharks (year-round wild interaction), Bicol cuisine (Michelin-recognized) — are genuinely world-class. The gap is entirely in marketing, accessibility, and quality standards, not in the tourism product itself. This is a structural advantage: product is harder to fix than marketing.

4.3 Detailed Benchmark Case Studies

4.3.1 Tourism New Zealand — Off-Peak Growth (Revenue +NZD \$5B)

WORLD STANDARD: NEW ZEALAND

Strategy: Grow international tourism revenue by NZD \$5B by 2028, with 70% from OFF-PEAK visitors. Key tactics: (1) Targeted campaigns for shoulder seasons targeting India, Australia, UK/Germany; (2) Airline partnership incentives for year-round routes; (3) Business events bidding to fill low season; (4) Trade training focused on off-peak products exclusively.

BICOL APPLICATION

Bicol's seasonality problem is the same as NZ's but more acute (3.9:1 peak-to-low vs NZ's 2.5:1). Adopt NZ's framework targeting: Bicolano diaspora (year-round), Indian travelers (post-visa-free 2025), MICE/events sector. Develop "Bicol in the Rainy Season" product line: indoor cultural experiences, food tourism, wellness retreats.

4.3.2 Thailand — Gastronomy Tourism (THB 230B/year)

WORLD STANDARD: THAILAND

Gastronomy Tourism generated THB 230+ billion (PHP 380B+) in 2024. Michelin Guide covers 7 cities. Each province has a signature dish campaign. Key: provincial dish certification, street food walking tours, cooking schools as destination anchors, year-round food festival calendar.

BICOL APPLICATION

Bicol's cuisine is one of PH's most distinctive. The Philippines was named Michelin's "Most Exciting Food Destination 2026." Create: Bicol Food Trail (20+ certified restaurants), Pili product innovation, cooking schools for tourists, food festival calendar across all 6 provinces. Target: 500K food tourists by 2028.

4.3.3 Bali, Indonesia — Desa Wisata Community Tourism

WORLD STANDARD: BALI

6M foreign tourists, 150+ tourism villages (Desa Wisata), 50K+ digital nomads. Key: Desa Wisata program — each village unique product; BSEO program — every village website optimized; Digital nomad visa — 6-month, tax-free; 50 influencer free trips/month.

BICOL APPLICATION

Launch 20 Desa Wisata-equivalent tourism villages in Bicol (107 municipalities available). Pilot digital nomad hubs in Naga and Legazpi. Establish influencer cohort program (10 trips/month). Design unified Bicol community tourism brand.

4.3.4 Kerala, India — Responsible Tourism (UNWTO Award)

WORLD STANDARD: KERALA

First UNWTO Responsible Tourism award winner. 18.5M visitors. Signature: "God's Own Country" brand (25+ years), Responsible Tourism mission, 4,000+ houseboats, Ayurveda wellness tourism, village life experiences.

BICOL APPLICATION

India is visa-free for PH entry since June 2025. Kerala's model of community-based wellness tourism is directly transferable to Bicol's hot springs, organic food heritage, and rural communities. Develop "Bicol Wellness Circuit" linking Tiwi, Bulusan, and Catanduanes.

4.3.5 Queenstown, New Zealand — Adventure Capital

WORLD STANDARD: QUEENSTOWN

3.5M visitors/year to a town of 29,000 (120:1 tourist:resident ratio). One strong brand ("Adventure Capital of the World") consistent 30+ years. Year-round product innovation. 12 international direct flight routes.

BICOL APPLICATION

Mayon is Bicol's anchor experience — the "bungy" that draws visitors. Need year-round product strategy: culture/food for rainy season, diving for transition months, festivals for peaks. Premium positioning for Mayon; value for community tourism.

4.3.6 Luang Prabang, Laos — UNESCO Heritage Model

WORLD STANDARD: LUANG PRABANG

800K visitors/year, UNESCO World Heritage since 1995, strict preservation, "slow tourism" positioning — visitors stay avg. 4.2 nights. No high-rises, no chain hotels in old town.

BICOL APPLICATION

Mayon's UNESCO nomination is Bicol's Luang Prabang moment. The global attention from UNESCO designation must be leveraged immediately. Position Bicol as "slow tourism" — quality experiences, longer stays, deeper engagement.

4.3.7 Da Nang, Vietnam — Infrastructure-Led Growth

WORLD STANDARD: DA NANG

8.5M visitors, transformed from transit city to destination through massive infrastructure investment. Golden Bridge (Cau Vang) became viral sensation generating billions in free media. Sun World Ba Na Hills resort attracts 3M+/year.

BICOL APPLICATION

Da Nang proves that one iconic attraction (like the Golden Bridge) can transform a destination's visibility. Bicol should invest in one "wow" signature experience — the Night Mayon Experience with light-and-sound show could serve this purpose.

4.3.8 Yogyakarta, Indonesia — Heritage + Creativity

WORLD STANDARD: YOGYAKARTA

6.8M visitors, 2 UNESCO sites (Borobudur, Prambanan). Named UNESCO Creative City of Gastronomy. Strong community-based tourism. Malioboro Street is the ultimate tourism night market — 2km of food, crafts, street performers.

BICOL APPLICATION

Yogyakarta's Malioboro Street model is directly applicable to Legazpi Boulevard and Naga's Magsaysay Avenue. A pedestrianized night market with local food, crafts, and performances would address Albay's evening economy gap.

4.3.9 Siem Reap, Cambodia — Single Asset Mastery

WORLD STANDARD: SIEM REAP

2.5M visitors, 90% foreign, anchored entirely by Angkor Wat. Demonstrated that a single world-class asset can drive an entire destination economy. Strong international air connectivity via Siem Reap-Angkor International Airport.

BICOL APPLICATION

Mayon has the same single-anchor potential. If Mayon achieves UNESCO designation and is marketed as aggressively as Angkor Wat, it could become the primary draw for international tourists. The airport-to-World Heritage connection is the critical investment.

4.3.10 Palawan, Philippines — Regional Benchmark

DOMESTIC BENCHMARK: PALAWAN

2.8M visitors, 15% foreign share (12x Bicol's). Strong international brand built over 15 years. 3 international airports (Puerto Princesa, El Nido, San Vicente). Multiple UNESCO designations.

BICOL VS. PALAWAN

Palawan is Bicol's most direct competitor for international nature tourism. Palawan's advantages: more international flights, longer international marketing history, multiple UNESCO sites. Bicol's advantages: Mayon (unique asset Palawan lacks), whale sharks (year-round, Palawan has seasonal), food culture, accessibility from Manila (closer).

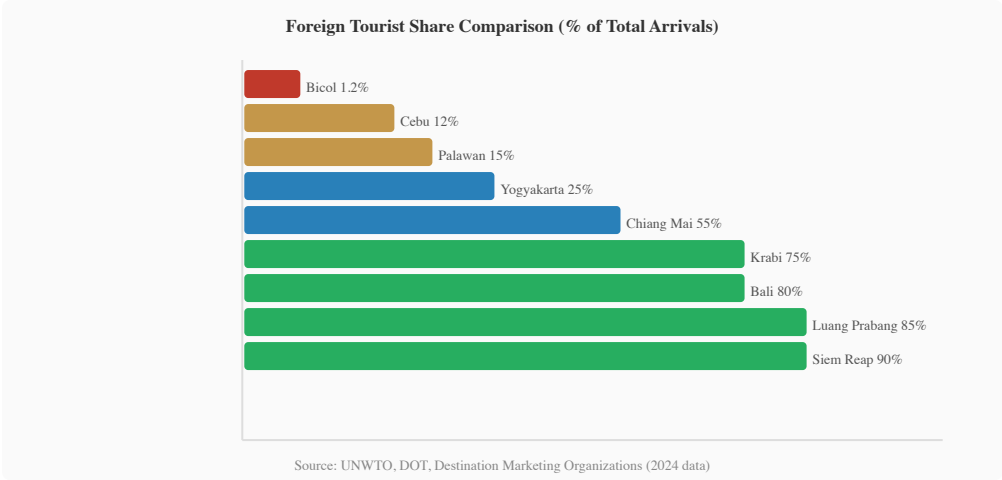


Figure 4.1: Bicol's 1.2% Foreign Share vs. Regional Peers — The widest gap in this entire Guidebook

5. Financial Analysis & Projections

5.1 Revenue Composition (2024)

Bicol tourism generated PHP 3.3 billion in direct tourism revenue in 2024. The composition reveals critical insights: activities and attractions account for only 5.7% of tourism spend – an indicator of limited monetization of Bicol's natural assets. By comparison, adventure destinations like Queenstown generate 30%+ of revenue from activities. Developing and marketing bookable experiences represents an PHP 800M+ annual revenue opportunity.

SOURCE	AMOUNT	%	GROWTH	ACTION TO INCREASE
Accommodation	PHP 1,420M	43.0%	+18.2%	Increase overnight ratio, develop mid-range options
Food & Beverage	PHP 890M	27.0%	+15.5%	Food trail, cooking classes, night markets
Transport (incl. tours)	PHP 520M	15.8%	+12.1%	Multi-day circuit packages
Shopping & Souvenirs	PHP 280M	8.5%	+9.8%	Pili product innovation, artisan markets
Activities & Attractions	PHP 190M	5.7%	+22.4%	ATV expansion, night Mayon, adventure products

5.2 Five-Year Financial Model

The financial model assumes: (1) continued domestic growth of 8-12%, (2) accelerated foreign growth via air access and digital marketing, (3) increasing per-visitor spend through product diversification, and (4) economic multiplier effects. The 78% revenue jump in 2026 assumes the launch of the digital marketing campaign and initial air access improvements.

YEAR	DOMESTIC	FOREIGN	TOTAL	REVENUE	REV/VISITOR
2024	4,381,598	54,275	4,435,873	PHP 3.3B	PHP 745
2025 (est.)	4,800,000	90,000	4,890,000	PHP 4.5B	PHP 920
2026	5,250,000	200,000	5,450,000	PHP 8.0B	PHP 1,468
2027	6,500,000	400,000	6,900,000	PHP 18.0B	PHP 2,609
2028	7,900,000	600,000	8,500,000	PHP 34.5B	PHP 4,059

REVENUE GROWTH ANALYSIS

The 10.4x revenue multiplier from PHP 3.3B to PHP 34.5B is aggressive but achievable through: (1) 1.9x more arrivals, (2) foreign mix from 1.2% to 7% (foreign tourists spend 2.6x more), (3) longer stays (1.8 to 4.2 nights), and (4) higher per-visitor spend through packaged experiences. Every PHP 1 invested in this plan is projected to generate PHP 187 in economic return.

5.3 Economic Multiplier Impact

SCENARIO	DIRECT 2028 REVENUE	MULTIPLIER	TOTAL IMPACT	JOBS
Conservative	PHP 34.5B	1.8x	PHP 62.1B	125,000
Moderate	PHP 34.5B	2.1x	PHP 72.4B	145,000
Optimistic	PHP 34.5B	2.4x	PHP 82.8B	165,000

Target: By 2028, tourism should support ~145,000 jobs in Bicol — approximately 15% of regional employment, up from an estimated 7% in 2024, representing over 90,000 new tourism-related jobs created during the plan period.

Bicol Region Tourism Strategic Guidebook 2026–2028

Department of Tourism Region V · Market and Product Development Division

Data sources: DOT Bicol, Philippine Statistics Authority, ASEAN Secretariat, UNWTO, WTTC

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